

Startup Funding Proposal
Rosendal Equestrian Experiences (REE)
Rosendal, Free State, South Africa

Date: May 26, 2026

Purpose: Secure startup funding for a small, practical tourism activity business.

1) Executive Summary

REE is a small startup focused on guided horse experiences for weekend visitors in Rosendal. The strategy is intentionally conservative: start small, control costs, prove demand, and grow only after stable monthly performance.

This proposal is designed for investors who want:

Modest initial capital requirements

Clear risk controls

Realistic pricing aligned to South African activity market ranges

Transparent milestones before scaling

2) Why This Can Work in Rosendal

Rosendal is a small town, so the business model is built around visitor demand, not local resident volume.

The model fits towns like Rosendal because:

Visitors already come for a quiet countryside experience

Accommodation operators need activity partners

Horse experiences are memorable, visual, and suitable for families/couples

3) Startup Scope (Keep It Small)

Phase 1 (first 6 months)

Launch with only 3 core products:

Scenic Ride (60 minutes)

Sunset Ride (75-90 minutes)

Kids Pony Ride (10-15 minutes)

Operating days: Friday to Sunday + public holidays

Approach: Low fixed costs, pre-booking preferred, strict weather/safety controls

4) Pricing (Recent & Reasonable)

Pricing is benchmarked to recent publicly listed South African trail/pony offers (2025-2026), where 1-hour trail rides often fall around R350-R750 and pony options are lower.

Recommended launch pricing (Rosendal startup level)

Kids Pony Ride (10-15 min): R120-R180

Scenic Ride (60 min): R380-R520 per person

Sunset Ride (75-90 min): R550-R750 per person

Private Couple Ride: R1,300?R1,900 per booking

These are intentionally moderate to avoid overpricing for a small-town startup.

5) Lean Capital Requirement

Funding ask (startup): R280,000

Use of funds (practical split)

28% Safety gear, tack, and setup essentials

20% Horse care reserve (feed, vet, farrier buffer)

15% Insurance and compliance costs

15% Basic marketing + content + booking setup

12% Working capital buffer

10% Route/site preparation and signage

This budget is enough to start responsibly without creating scale pressure too early.

6) Monthly Cost Discipline (Target)

Key monthly cost buckets:

Horse care

Guide/support wages

Fuel/transport

Insurance

Partner commissions (if referred bookings)

Marketing and admin

Control rule: Keep fixed overhead low; use variable staffing around demand peaks.

7) Revenue Model (Simple)

Monthly revenue is based on booked slots only:

Scenic bookings scenic rate

Sunset bookings sunset rate

Pony rides pony rate

Private rides package rate

Unit economics rule

Do not expand products that consistently produce weak contribution margins.

8) Partnership-Led Sales Plan

Primary channel: Rosendal accommodation partners.

Give each partner a clear booking/referral process

Offer fair referral commissions (e.g., 10?20% depending on volume)

Focus on same-day response and reliable guest handling

Secondary channels:
WhatsApp bookings
Google Business Profile
Instagram/Facebook content

9) Safety, Legal, and Welfare (Non-Negotiable)

Before commercial launch:

Signed indemnity forms
Rider screening (age/size/confidence)
Pre-ride safety briefing
Incident procedure
Public liability cover
Vet/farrier/welfare logs
Weather cancellation policy

Small business does not mean small safety standards.

10) Risk & Mitigation (Realistic)

Low-demand weekends

Mitigation: Flexible staffing, partner bundles, seasonal offers.

Bad weather disruptions

Mitigation: Clear reschedule terms and weather buffers.

Safety incidents

Mitigation: SOPs, training, conservative rider matching, insurance.

Cashflow pressure early months

Mitigation: Lean cost base, strict cash tracking, phased spending.

11) Milestones (First 12 Months)

Months 1?2

Finalize compliance, forms, and SOPs
Confirm first accommodation partners
Soft launch limited slots

Months 3?6

Stabilize weekend operations
Track demand by product and partner
Adjust pricing only after data

Months 7?12

Improve occupancy and repeat bookings
Add one premium add-on only if margins support it
Prepare small expansion case for year 2

12) Investor Offer

REE is seeking startup funding of R280,000 to launch responsibly and prove the model in Rosendal.

Investors receive:

Monthly operational updates

Quarterly performance summary

Milestone-based spending discipline

A realistic growth path without aggressive assumptions

Closing Note

This is a practical startup, not a large-scale tourism rollout. The plan is intentionally right-sized for Rosendal: begin small, run professionally, protect downside, and scale only when the numbers justify it.